

and access a shared folder on the network, only to be greeted by a Login/Password prompt. The login is usually <Name>/Guest. This is very frustrating for people trying to access your shares for work. You can get rid of this by going to **Control Panel > Administrative Tools > Local Security Policy > Local Policy > Security Options**. Here, double-click on "Network access: Sharing and security model for local accounts," and select the option "Classic - local users authenticate as themselves" from the drop-down box. Apply the settings and you're done.

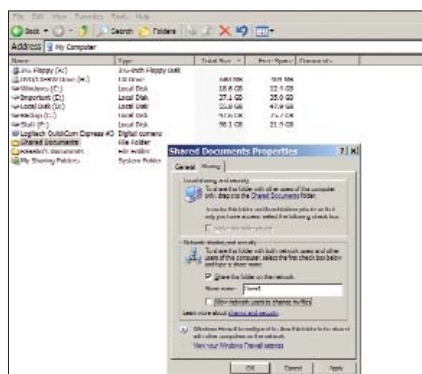
Hiding From Network Neighborhood

If you want to share folders on your computer but do not want them to be visible to others when they go to Network Neighbourhood, just go to **Start > Run**, type in "net config server /hidden:yes", and press [Enter].

So Long, Shared Documents

By default, your Shared Documents folder is shared over the network. This is irritating because if one computer in the network gets a virus or worm, it usually ends up in everyone's Shared Documents folder. There are two ways to go about avoiding this. Find this folder in Documents and Settings, right-click on it and select "Sharing and Security...". Share the folder over the network as docs\$, or something with a "\$" sign at the end. This will make it invisible to the rest of the network. You can also set it to share as read only by unchecking the "Allow Network Users to Change my Files" box.

The second way is to open the Registry Editor, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer**, create a new DWORD Value (if it doesn't already exist) called "NoSharedDocuments", set its value to "1", and then reboot the computer.



Dollar-share the Shared Documents folder

Troubleshooting

Tools

There are a few interesting troubleshooting tools that are not installed in the default installation of Windows XP. If you have the installation CD, you will find them in the \Support\Tools\ directory. Just run SETUP.EXE in this directory to install them. Here are a few examples:

diruse: This utility shows you the disk usage of your drives

dupfinder: Identify duplicate files, so you can free up disk space

getmac: A simply utility that will tell you the MAC address of your NIC (network card)

netdiag: Tests and diagnoses your network components

pvviewer: Shows you a list of processes, and allows you to see how much memory each process uses, and to kill processes individually

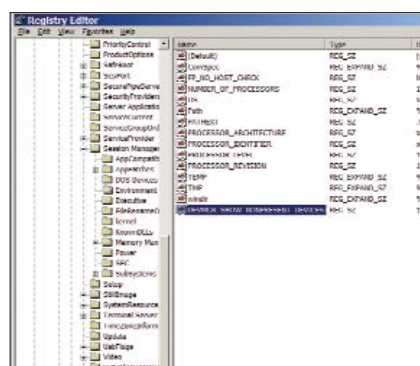
Driver List

You can troubleshoot driver issues by using the "driverquery" utility. The easiest way to do this is to use the utility to output its data to a CSV (comma separated value) file, so that you can import it into MS Excel, and get a nice, clean results table. The command to do this is "driverquery /v /fo > drivers.csv". Here, you can substitute "drivers.csv" with any filename you like.

Hidden Devices

There is a list of hidden devices that do not normally show up in the Device Manager. You can get XP to reveal these by either changing a Registry entry, or by creating a batch file to launch the Device Manager with the correct options.

If you're comfortable with the Registry, open the Registry Editor and navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\ControlSet001\Control\Session Manager\Environment**. Here, create a String Value called **DEVMGR_SHOW_NONPRESENT_DEVICES**, and give it a



Show hidden devices in Device Manager

value of 1. If you'd rather create a batch file, open Notepad, and type in the following:

```
@Echo Off
Prompt $p$g
set
DEVMGR_SHOW_NONPRESENT_DEVICES=1
start devmgmt.msc
exit
```

Then save it as "devmgmt.bat". You can use any descriptive filename you like with the .bat extension.

Shortcuts

Quick Access To Control Panel Applets

If you're a keyboard warrior and don't really like going to **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs**, or the likes, you will love these shortcuts. Just press [Windows] + [R], type in one of the following, and press [Enter].

appwiz.cpl will open the Add/Remove Programs dialog

desk.cpl will open the Display Properties dialog

firewall.cpl opens your Windows Firewall settings

inetcpl.cpl will take you straight to Internet Options

mmsys.cpl will open the Sound and Audio Devices controller

ncpa.cpl will open Network Connections

nusrmgr.cpl opens the User Accounts window

powercfg.cpl will take you to the Power Options Properties dialog

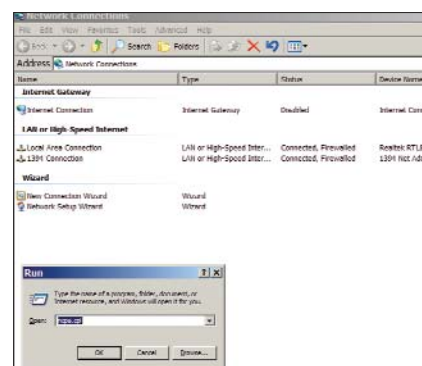
sysdm.cpl will open System Properties. You can also just use [Windows] + [Pause/Break]!

wscui.cpl opens up the Security Center

wuauclt.cpl opens up the Automatic Updates Configuration window

Suspend Shortcut

If you like to use Windows XP's Suspend feature so that you can quickly get back to what you were



Use Run shortcuts to get to common tasks